

Eight illustrations for macroeconomics website

We need an illustrator / graphics designer with a firm grasp of macroeconomics.

You should be a talented illustrator *and* have knowledge of macroeconomic concepts.

Illustrating macroeconomic concepts is challenging - and not very rewarding - if you have no serious interest in economics, this offer is not worth your time.

Who we are

We are the [ZEW Institute](#), a German economic research institute, mostly state funded.

We do research for the benefit of Europe and society as a whole.

You will compete to do a contract work for the department [Public Finance](#).

Here are the [people](#) you will do the work for.

You will work with [Peter Buchmann](#) and [Jan Kemper](#). Decision of the winning bid will also include [Prof. Heinemann](#).

Tender and payment

The tender is competitive and has two stages.

First stage: You produce two conceptual illustrations that indicate how you would fulfill the complete contract.

There will be two weeks time for this stage.

The best three applications will each receive a €50 thank-you payment.

Then we will choose the best bid among those leading three. The best bid will be awarded the full contract of 400€.

The full contract consists of EIGHT distinct images / illustrations. You can pick two color schemes of your choice. The most important images are the symbols for “dovish” and “hawkish” monetary policy. Details below. Of those two images, we need a simplified version for the legend bottom right. For the two competitive illustrations, at least one should be for “dovish” or “hawkish”. You have three weeks time.

Additional reward: Your name and picture will be listed at third position at the “team” page. We will write a two sentence statement - explaining and recommending your contribution. Your name will be linked to your personal online portfolio as quality reference for you for other clients. (your portfolio website cannot contain indecent stuff of course).

Your productions will also be listed on the “image credits” page.

The website will be published in September 2026 under <https://ecb-monitor.zew.de>

Even now, the pre-release data received wide media attention. For instance the data from [screen 02c](#) was printed in two-column size in the leading German “Handelsblatt” newspaper. Chances are, your work will be seen by many media people and financial professionals.

You must give us full exclusive copyright buyout though. Your works will only be used for the aforementioned project. As we are a research institute, we will not use your works for any commercial purpose.

Payment will be made within 10 business days.

We would prefer payment via Paypal or SWIFT bank transfer. Make sure you have a Paypal account - or a bank account that is capable of receiving money via SWIFT.

Africa, Asia, South America

While our work has a focus on Europe, we welcome people from other continents and different backgrounds.

You live in a small village in Brazil? You are from Bangalore in India?

You only need Internet access, English language and some talent in graphics and economics.

Task

Improve existing graphics and symbol pictures for several web pages.

The section [Website Screens](#) contains all major frames of the existing website.

All screens have a second version `..._redesign.jpg`. The color magenta shows those areas that need to be re-created.

The other areas should not be changed - unless you have a compelling aesthetic vision.

Keep in mind, that the website is a sub-site of our main website <https://www.zew.de> and should not deviate too much from our CI.

First part - Home page

[Screen 01](#) defines the work to be done.

Define the first color scheme. You can stick with the existing “iceblue” and “zew green”, or choose two other colors from section [images from ZEW institute](#).

Then design the six section graphics.

You can use ideas (but you cannot copy anything) from the Economist magazine.

<https://www.economist.com/topics/finance-and-economics>

<https://www.economist.com/topics/free-exchange>

<https://www.economist.com/schools-brief>

<https://www.economist.com/topics/graphic-detail>

The graphics do not need to be super fine-grained - rough shapes that can be easily recognized are preferred.

Again: Look at the examples in at the Economist website.

The most important challenge here is to find illustrations for the actual content of the sections.

For instance: The second section should easily convey the topic “Inside the brains of ECB directors” or “Inside the mechanism of the ECB” - or “credit expansion and contraction”. Do not use commonplace symbols like the percentage sign to symbolize interest rates - or the Euro symbol to symbolize “money supply”. We make this tender to get creative yet intuitive illustrations.

Do not try to trace or copy *The Economist* illustrations - this is easily detectable and will disqualify you.

Second part - color scheme “dovish” - “hawkish”.

Define the second color scheme.

Screens [02a](#), [02b](#) and [02c](#) all feature a gradient between two anchor colors.

First color is currently violet-blue and should be associated with “liquidity”, “dovish monetary policy”, “low interest rates”, “easy credit”, “expansion”, “inflation”.

Second is currently yellow-orange. It should be associated with “hawkish monetary policy”, “scarce liquidity”, “higher interest rates”, “less money available”, “price stability”, “anti-inflation”.

- You can keep the existing colors.
- You can also define *your* colors.
- You may also use our ZEW colors (folder [inspiration-zew-colors](#)) - if you can find a semantically suitable mapping for “dovish” and “hawkish”.
The section [images from ZEW institute](#) contains some example graphics using the ZEW color scheme.
- Dont use “value judgement” colors: “red” and “green” would imply that one is good - and the other is bad.
Neither “dovish” nor “hawkish” positions are “good” or “bad”..

Color Saturation Please create the second part graphics in *fully* saturated colors.

The web pages have an “opacity” setting (visible bottom right) so users can make the colors more or less opaque / garish.

If a user visits the page the first time, the opacity of all graphics is set to 50 percent.

Thus, produce the graphics in full intensity colors (this looks really intense - I know), since they will be “de-saturated” in the design of the website.

Exception: Home page graphics - these will be displayed exactly as you produce them - here a moderate, modest color saturation is probably best.

No AI

The draft images given were created with AI.

Please don't use any AI in creating the production images. Please don't use AI for any small details either - as its shapes and gradients have salient aesthetics and characteristics that destroy any creative value.

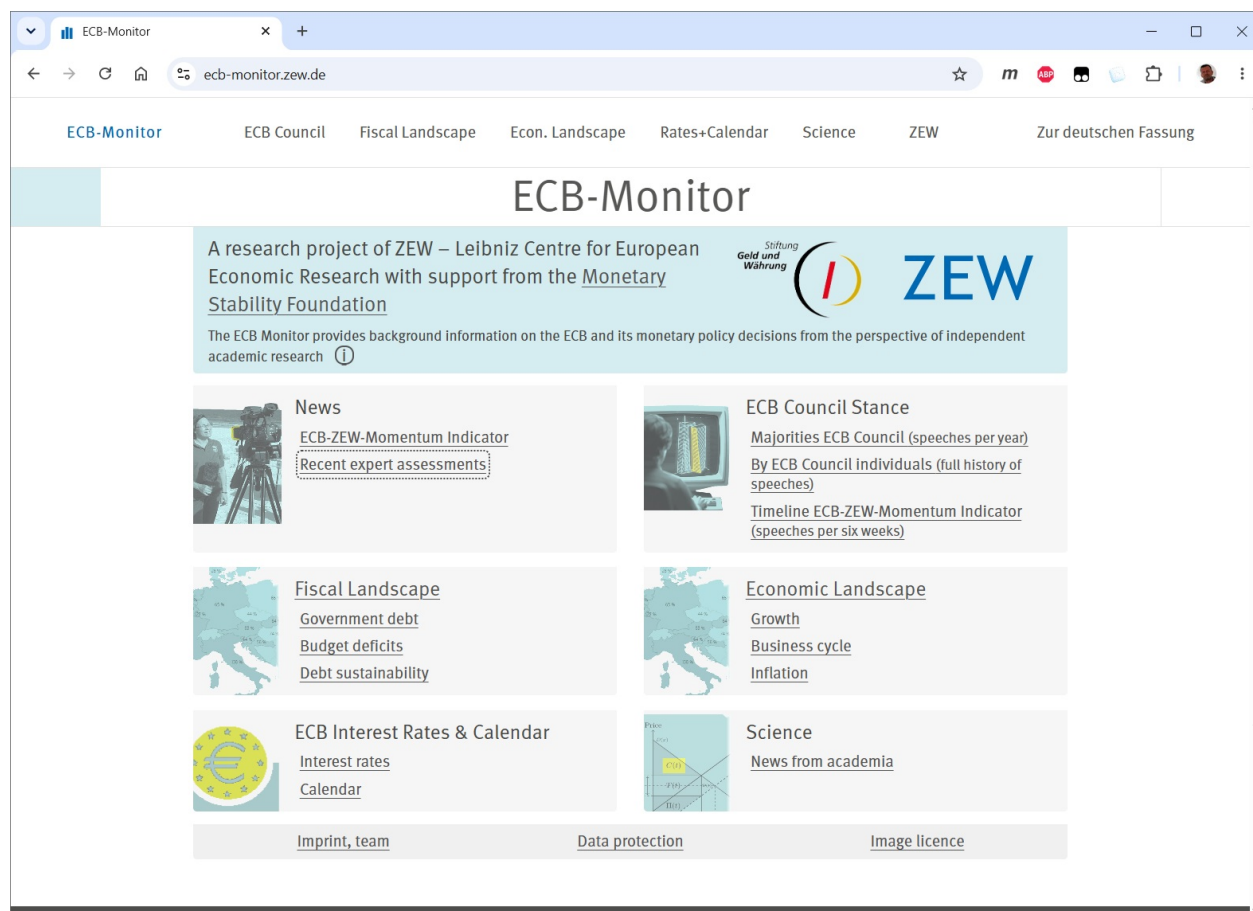
Format

SVG or Vector graphics welcome.

PNG or any other pixel format also nice, sufficient resolution 1600 x 1600 pixel or higher

Website Screens

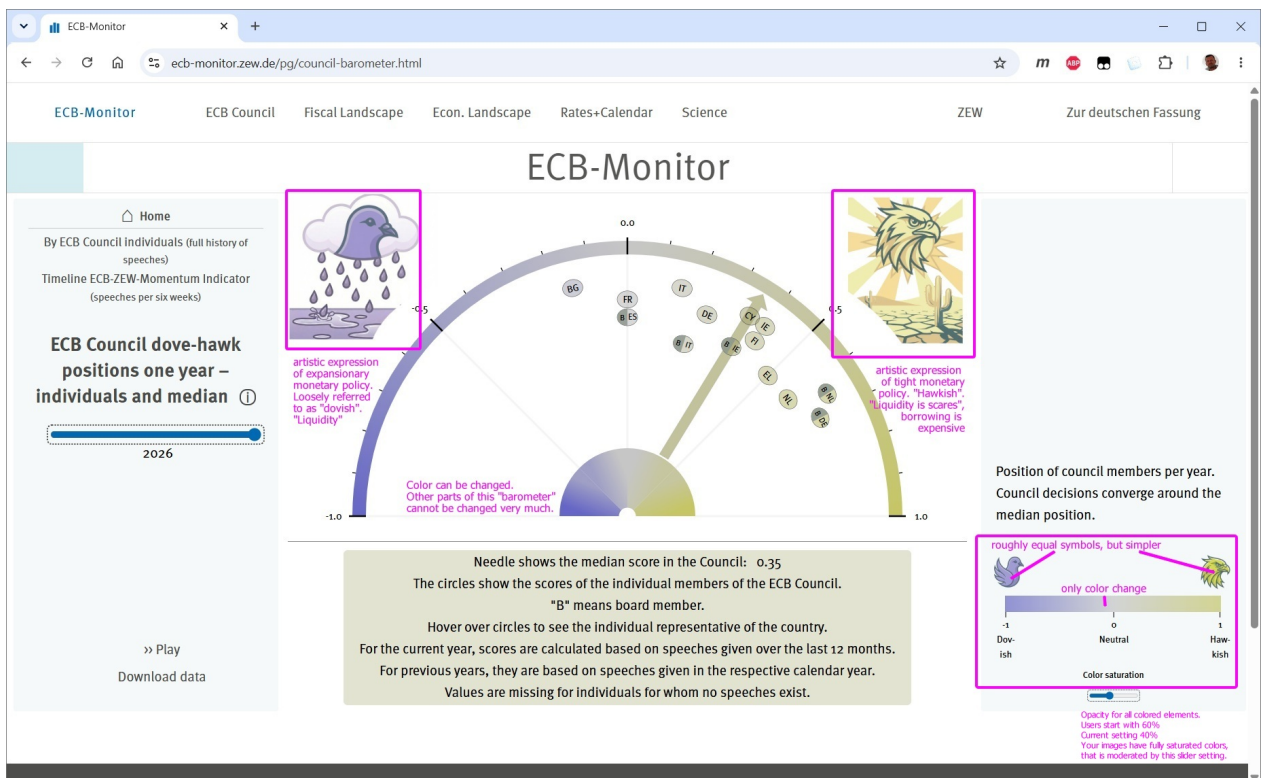
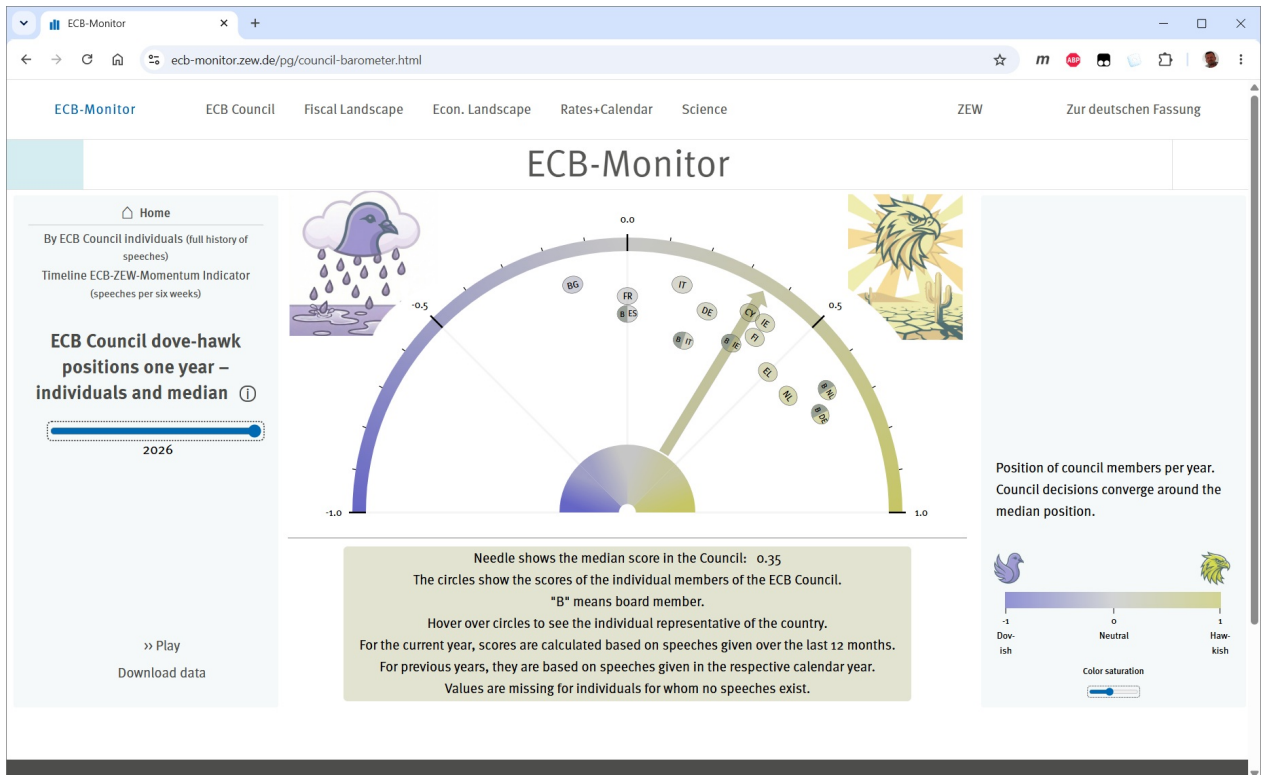
Screen 01



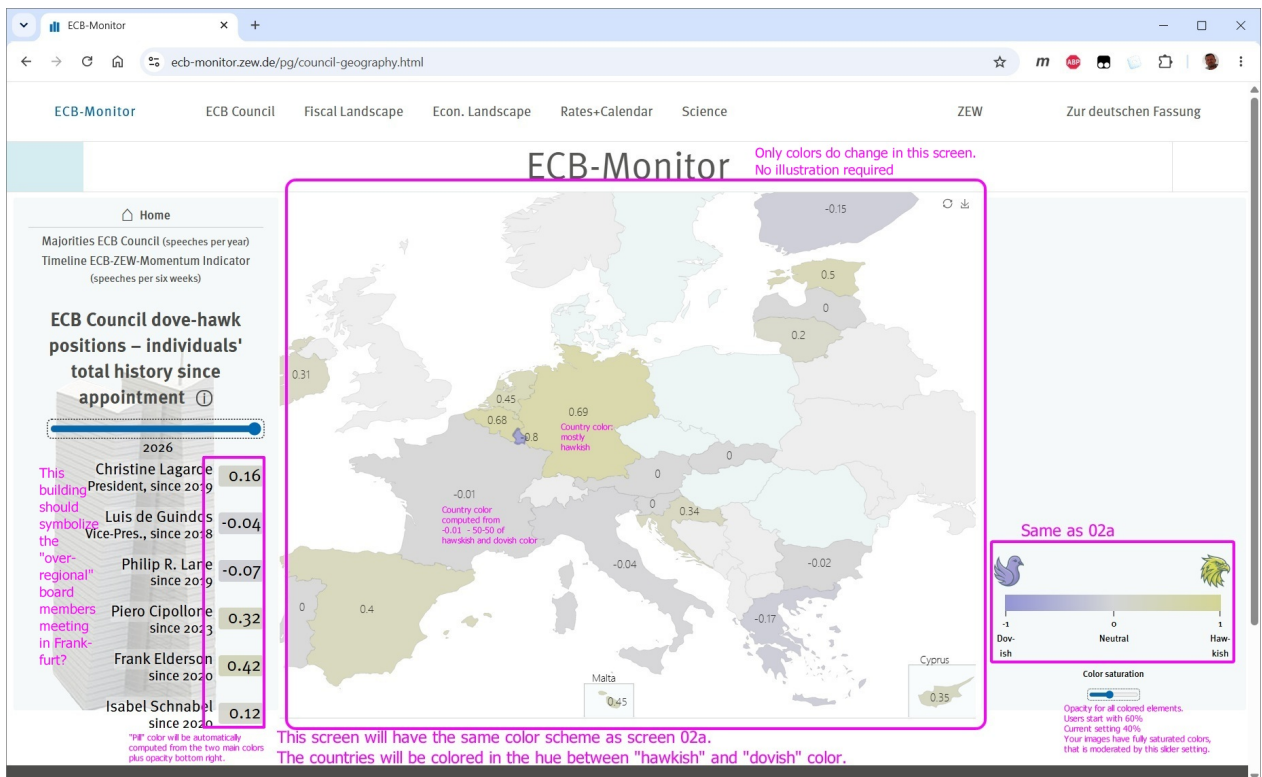
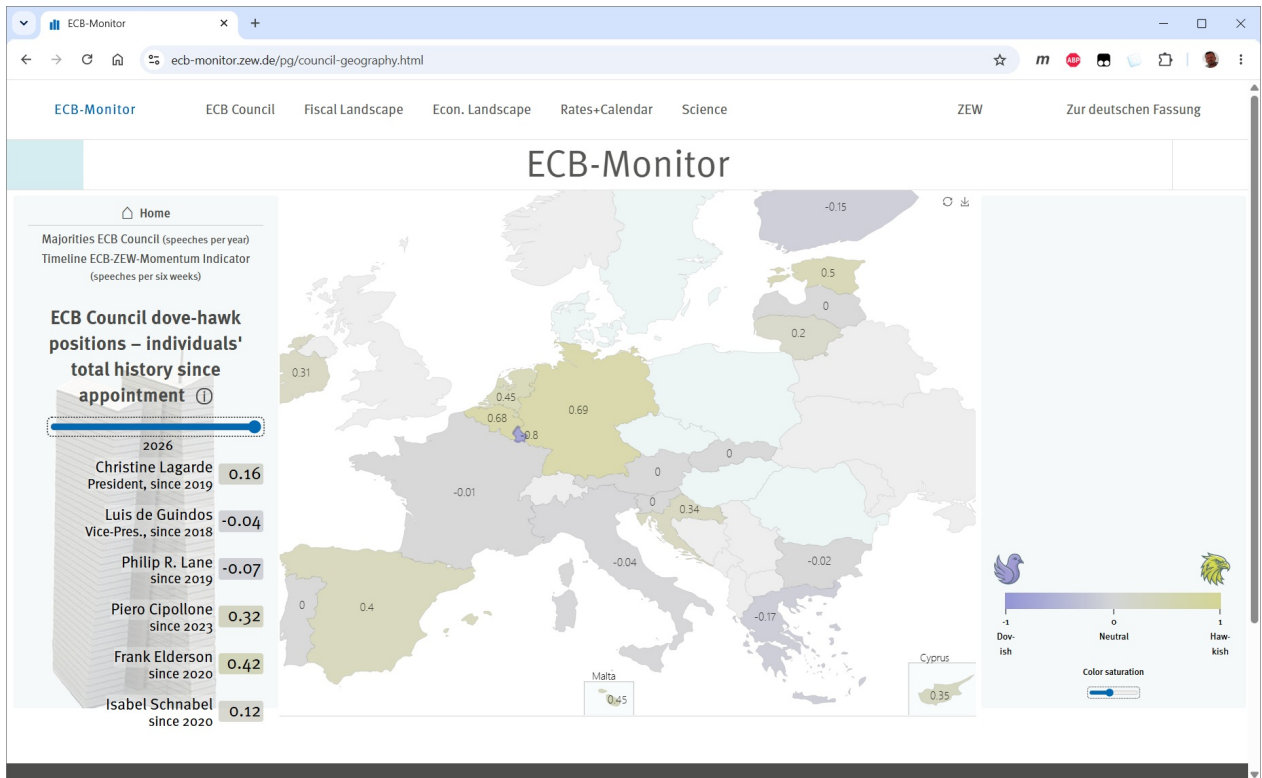


Screens 02

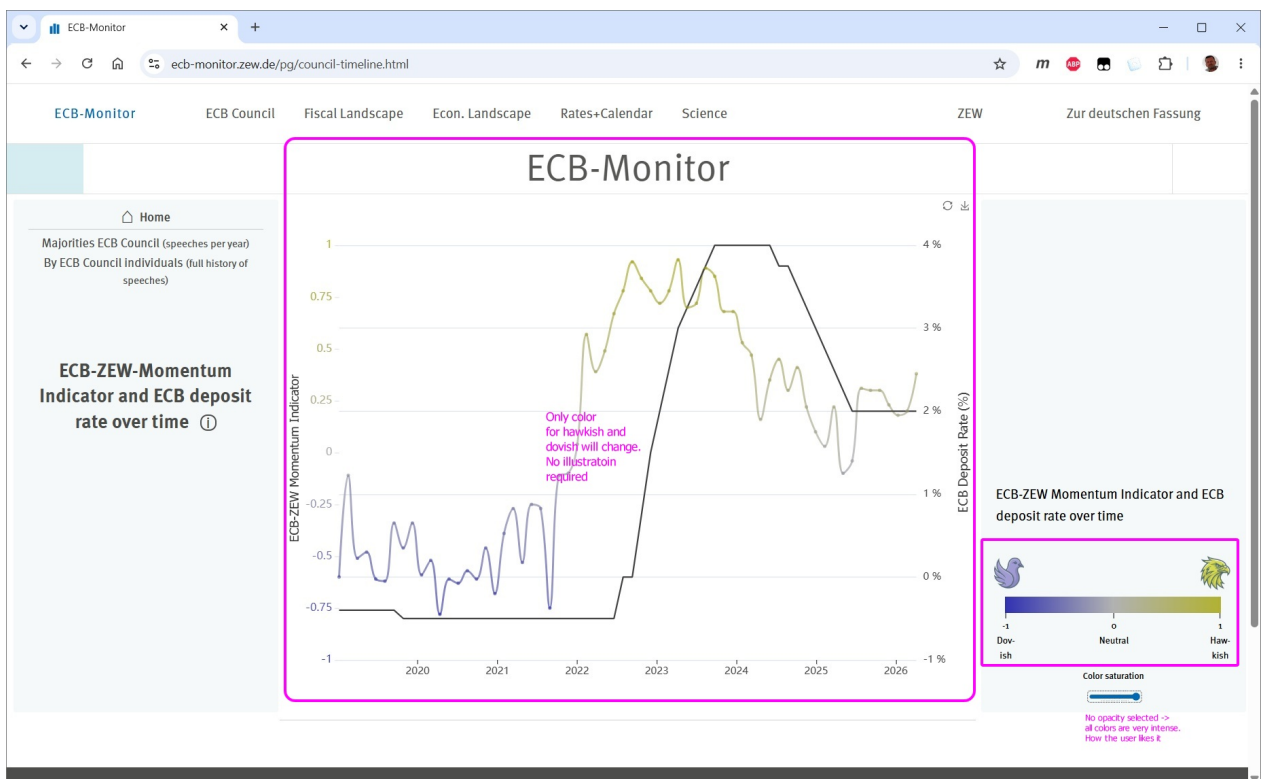
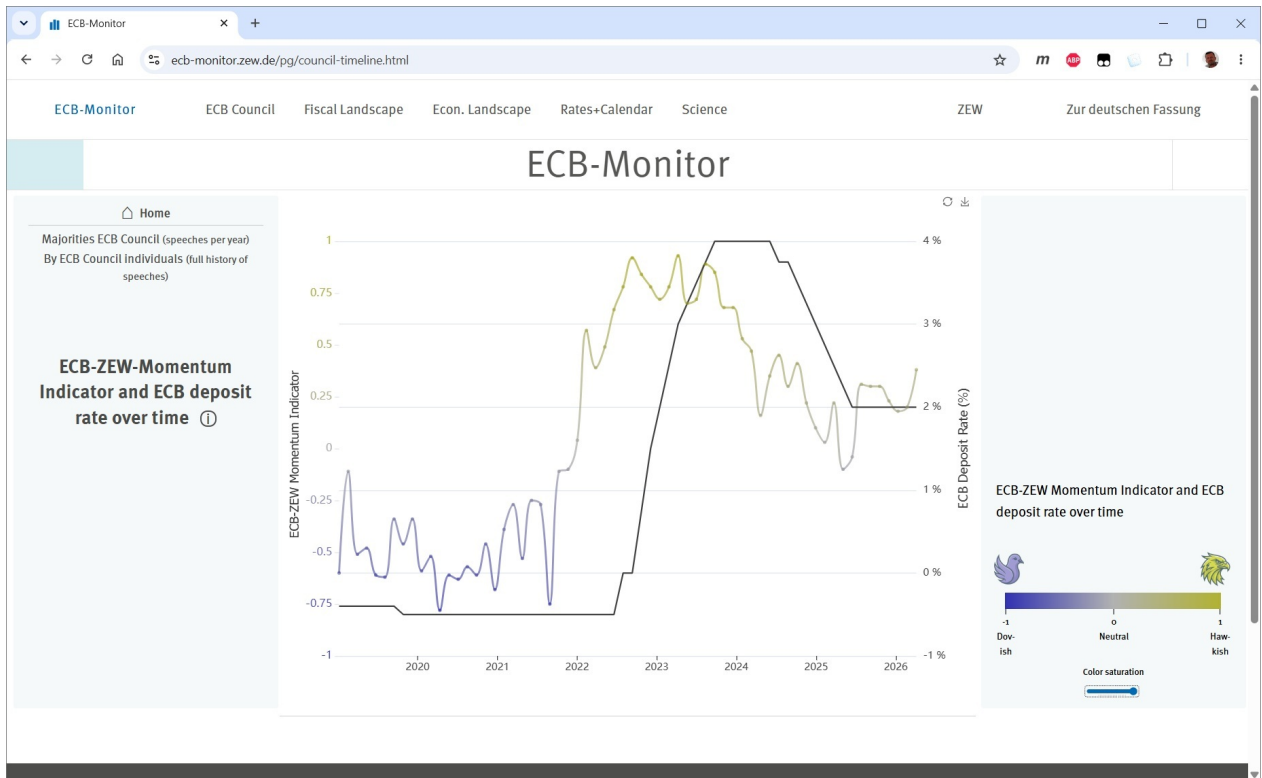
Screens 02a



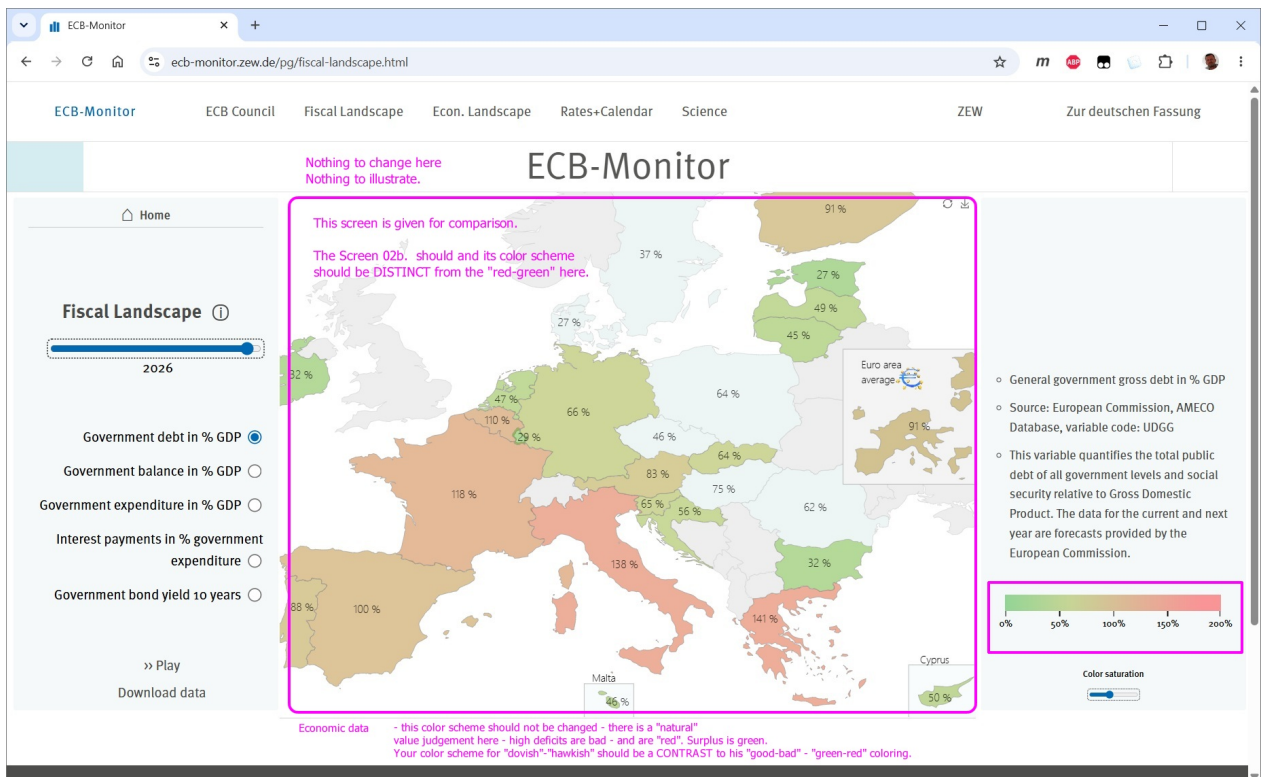
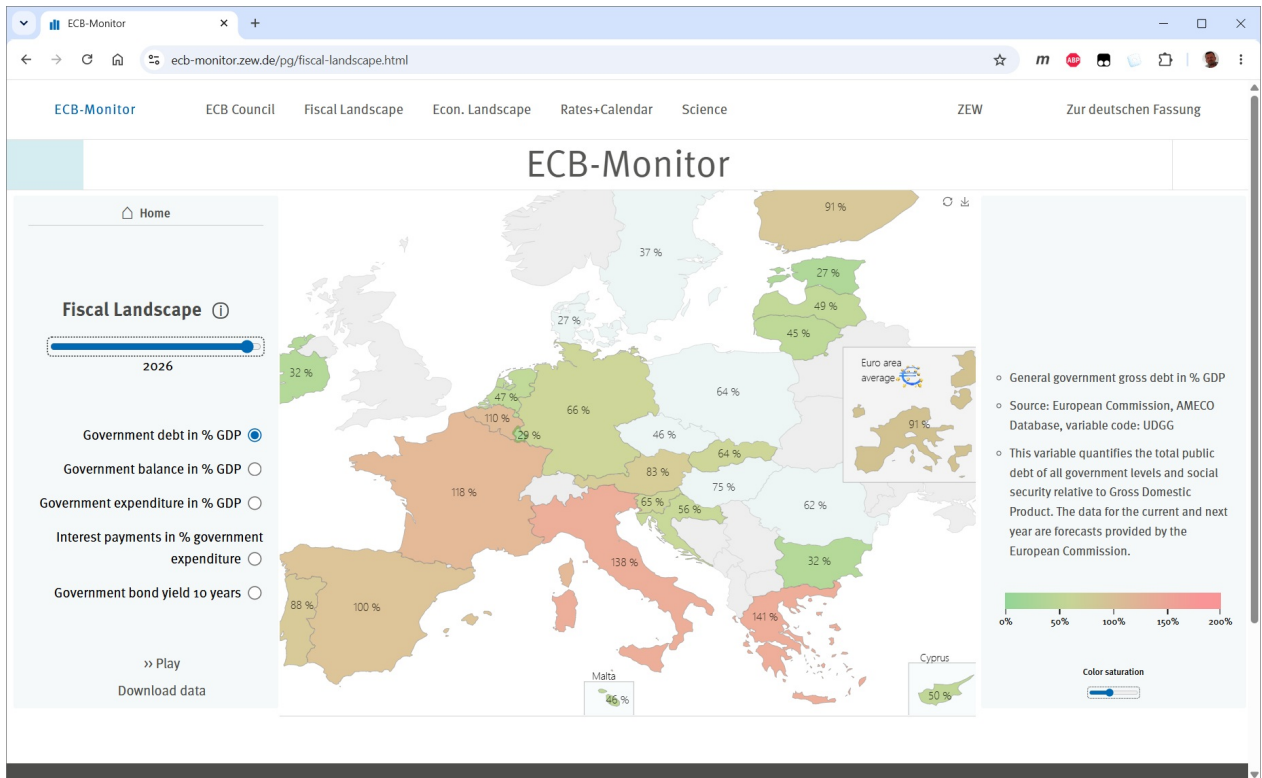
Screens 02b



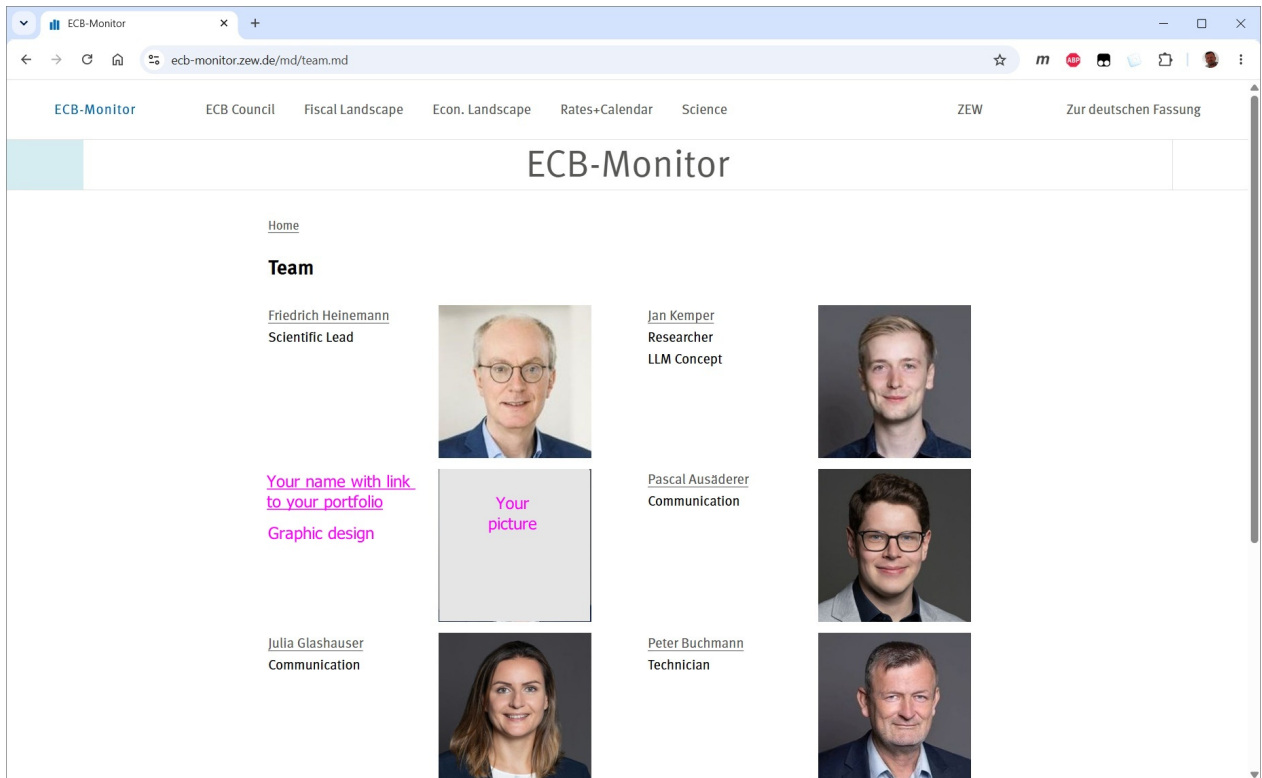
Screens 02c



Screen 03



Screen 04



Screens mobile

Mobile devices:

Switch from
two column layout
to single column

Illustrations
should be the
same in
Desktop and
in mobile view.

ECB Council Fiscal Land-
scape Econ. Land-
scape Rates-
+Calendar Science Zur
deutschen
Fassung

ECB-Monitor

A research project of ZEW –
Leibniz Centre for European
Economic Research with
support from the Monetary
Stability Foundation



ZEW

The ECB Monitor provides background information on the
ECB and its monetary policy decisions from the perspec-
tive of independent academic research 



News

ECB-ZEW-Momentum Indicator

Recent expert assessments



ECB Council Stance

Majorities ECB Council (speeches per
year)

By ECB Council individuals (full his-
tory of speeches)

Timeline ECB-ZEW-Momentum
Indicator (speeches per six weeks)



Fiscal Landscape

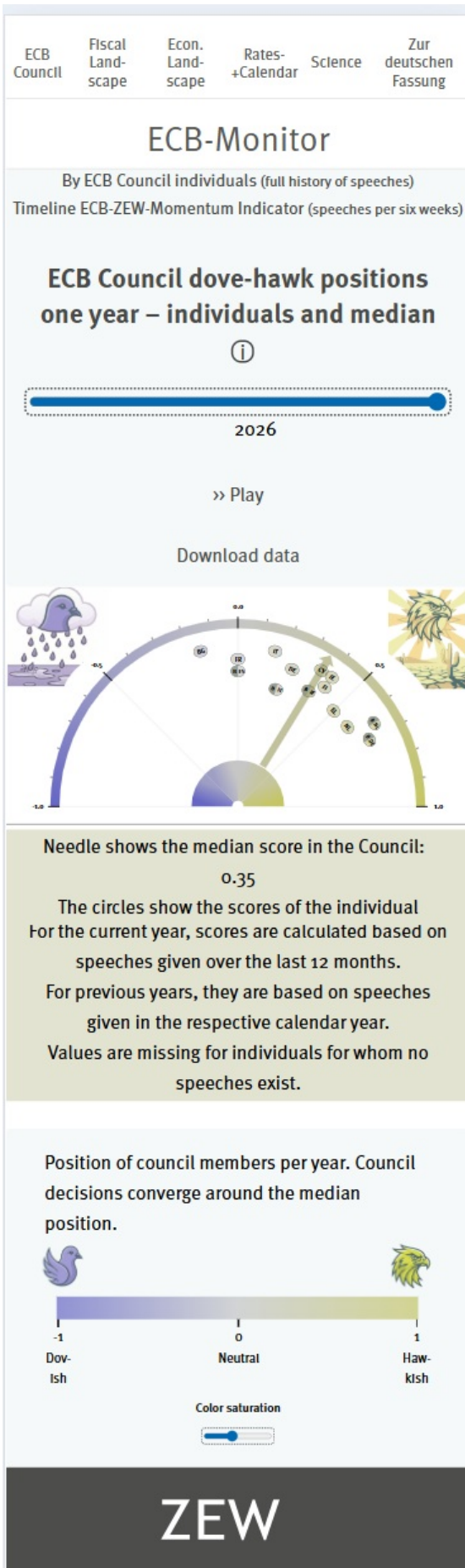
Government debt

Budget deficits

Debt sustainability



Economic Landscape

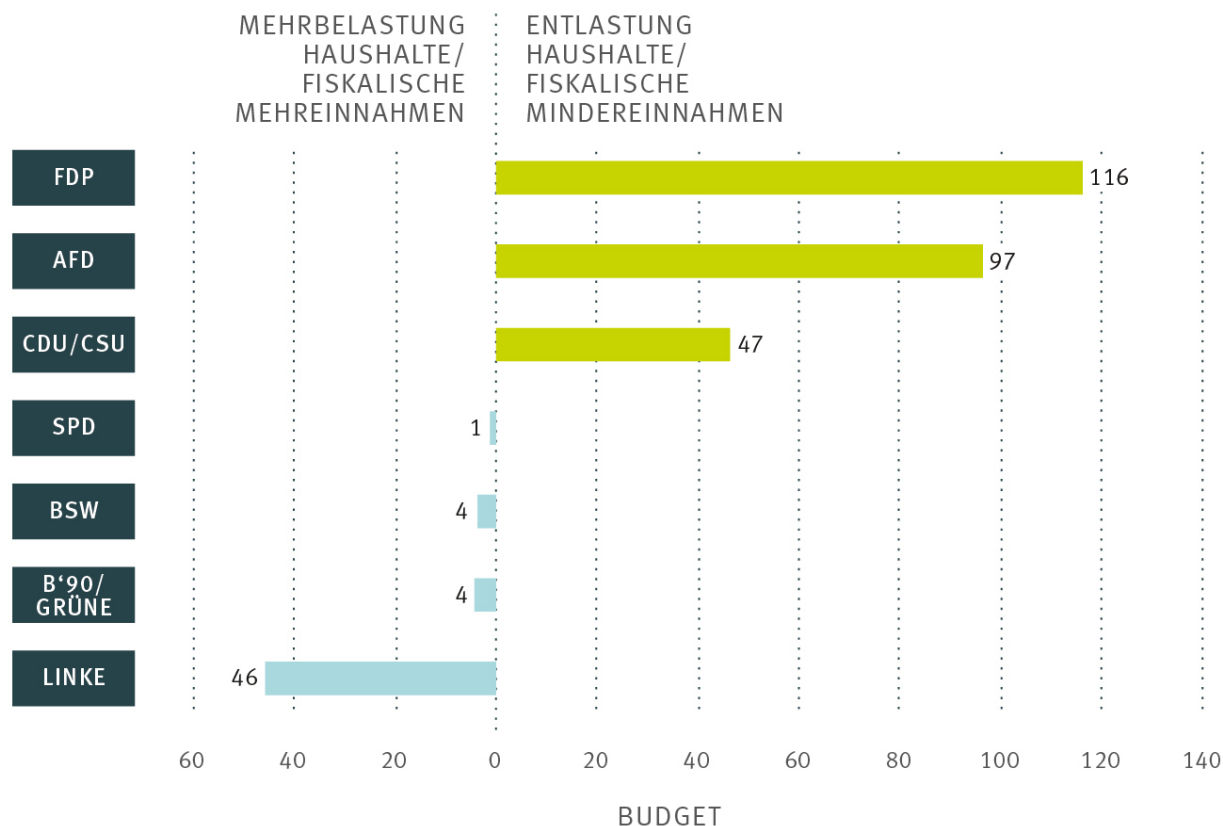


The critical screen 02a in mobile view.

Illustrations are the same, there is just a cutout section at the bottom right and bottom left - to reduce the required width.

Data charts from ZEW institute - inspiration

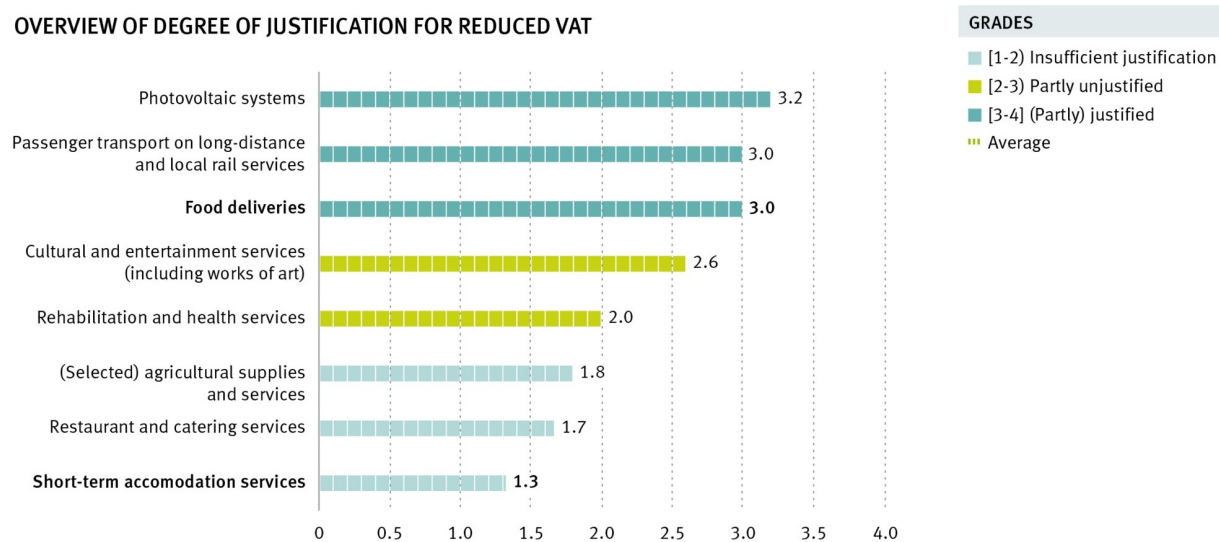
FISKALISCHE EFFEKTE DER JEWEILIGEN WAHLPROGRAMME AUF DEN GESAMTHAUSHALT IN MRD. EURO



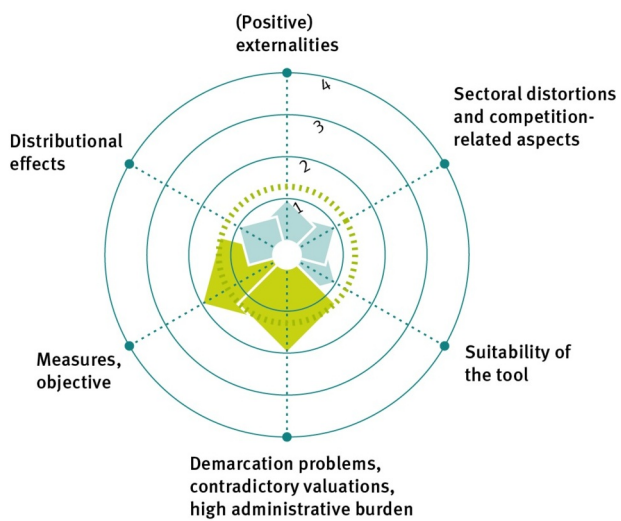
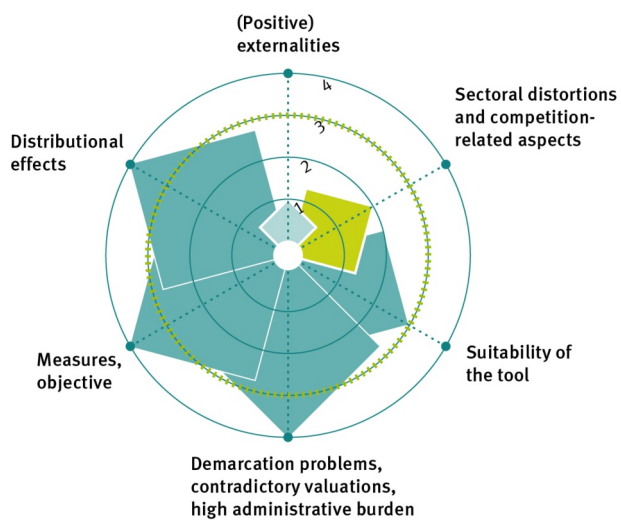
Quelle: ZEW-EviSTA

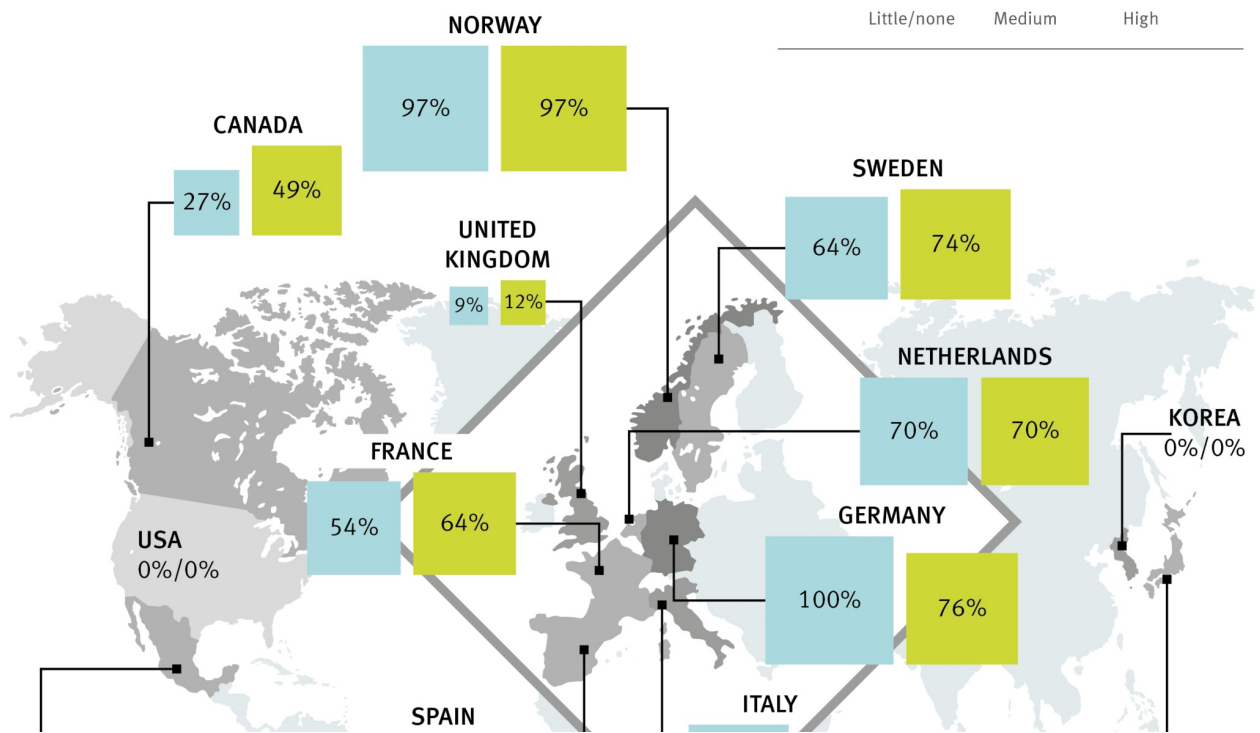
© ZEW

OVERVIEW OF DEGREE OF JUSTIFICATION FOR REDUCED VAT



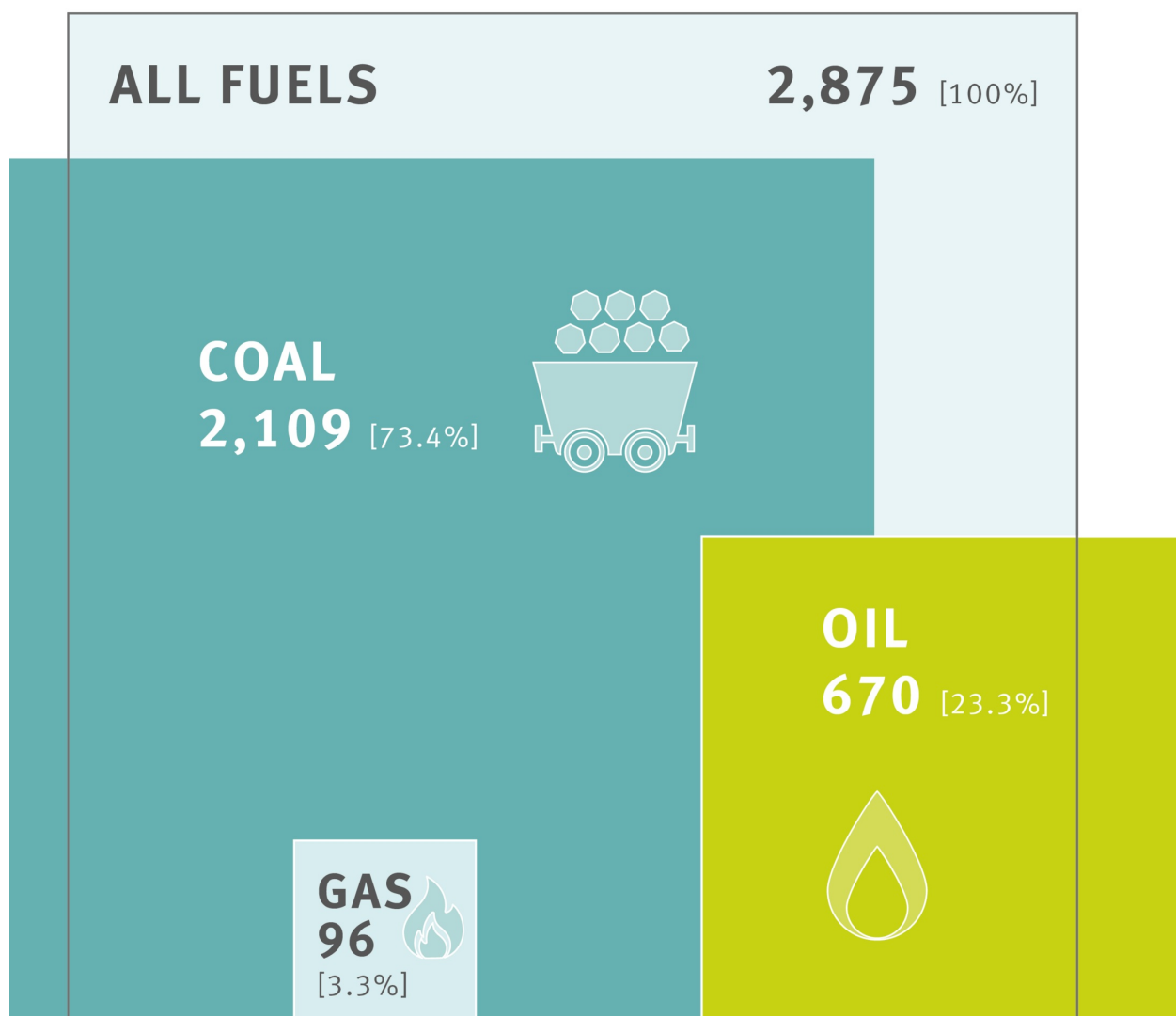
FOOD DELIVERIES





DAMAGE CAUSED BY AIR POLLUTION

(SHARE OF INDIVIDUAL FOSSIL FUELS IN TOTAL DAMAGE,
IN PER CENT AND IN MILLION USD)



VERÄNDERUNG DES VERFÜGBAREN JAHRESEINKOMMENS EHEPAAR 2 KINDER ALLEINVERDIENER

BRUTTOEINKOMMEN (IN EURO)	SPD	LINKE	B'90/ GRÜNE	FDP	CDU/CSU	AFD	BSW
40.000	860	6.150	870	-1.520	300	-440	1.010
60.000	1.300	6.980	960	4.800	850	5.400	1.790
80.000	1.400	7.050	810	4.050	1.440	9.630	1.600
120.000	1.520	5.180	670	7.890	2.770	12.310	1.220
180.000	2.200	-800	100	11.990	5.840	19.190	0

MUSTERHAUSHALT EHEPAAR MIT ZWEI KINDERN, ALLEINVERDIENER.

Quelle: ZEW-EviSTA

© ZEW

✕ Unsere
Themen

Altersvorsorge &
Green Finance
Arbeit &
Sozialversicherungen
Digitalisierung
Gesundheit
Innovation &
Unternehmen
Marktdesign

ALTERSVORSORGE UND NACHHALTIGE FINANZMÄRKTE

Der Forschungsbereich „Altersvorsorge und nachhaltige Finanzmärkte“ analysiert die Herausforderungen für Altersvorsorgesysteme und Finanzbranche, die durch globale Trends – wie demografischer Wandel, Digitalisierung und Klimawandel – entstehen.

➤ Alle Inhalte zum Forschungsbereich

➤ Das Team

SCHWERPUNKTE

➤ Banken und Finanzintermediation

➤ Finanzen privater Haushalte



Possible platforms

- **Upwork** (Best for milestone-based escrow and global reach)
- **Fiverr** (Best for fixed-price, specific deliverables)
- **Freelancer.com** (Suitable for the contest-style Stage 1 approach)
- **Behance Jobs** (Higher quality, portfolio-driven)
- **Dribbble Jobs** (High quality UI/UX and vector illustrators)
- **99designs** (Built specifically for the contest/spec-work model you proposed for Stage 1)